SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 14: Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development,
RECALLING ALSO that the Assembly, at its thirtieth session, in December 2017, recognized the ongoing problem of marine plastic pollution, as addressed in MARPOL Annex V, which required further consideration as part of a global solution within the framework of ocean governance, in pursuance of the target of SDG 14 to prevent and significantly reduce marine pollution of all kinds by 2025,
RECALLING FURTHER that it, at its seventy -third session in October 2018, adopted, by resolution MEPC.310(73), the Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships,
RECALLING that it, at its seventy-seventh session in November 2021, adopted, by resolution MEPC.341(77), the Strategy to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships,
RECALLING ALSO the obligation of Member States to provide adequate facilities at ports and terminals for the reception of garbage, as required by regulation 8 of MARPOL Annex V, and ensure this obligation is implemented effectively,
RESOLUTION MEPC.404(83) (adopted on 11 April 2025)

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SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
terminals for the reception of garbage, as required by regulation 8 of MARPOL Annex V, and ensure this obligation is implemented effectively,
RESOLUTION MEPC.404(83) (adopted on 11 April 2025)
2025 ACTION PLAN TO ADDRESS MARINE PLASTIC LITTER FROM SHIPSMEPC 83/17/Add.1
Annex 12, page 2
I:\MEPC\MEPC 83-17-Add.1.docx
1 ADOPTS the 2025 Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships (hereinafter the 2025 Action Plan) as set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2 NOTES the application of the 2025 Action Plan to all ships, including fishing vessels;
3 INVITES Member States, international organizations and other relevant bodies to undertake further studies to better understand discharges of marine plastic litter, in particular microplastics, from ships;
4 INVITES the Secretary-General of the Organization to make adequate provisions in the Integrated Technical Cooperation Programme to support relevant follow -up actions of the 2025 Action Plan;
5 AGREES to keep the 2025 Action Plan under review, with a view to assessing, in 2030, the effectiveness of the actions within the Action Plan against the intended outcomes;

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SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
actions of the 2025 Action Plan;
5 AGREES to keep the 2025 Action Plan under review, with a view to assessing, in 2030, the effectiveness of the actions within the Action Plan against the intended outcomes;
6 ALSO AGREES that the 2025 Action Plan supersedes the Action Plan adopted by resolution MEPC.310(73).
RESOLUTION MEPC.404(83) (adopted on 11 April 2025)
2025 ACTION PLAN TO ADDRESS MARINE PLASTIC LITTER FROM SHIPSMEPC 83/17/Add.1
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ANNEX
2025 ACTION PLAN TO ADDRESS MARINE PLASTIC LITTER FROM SHIPS

1 Background
1.1 Marine plastic litter enters the marine environment as a result of a wide range of land- and sea-based activities. Both macroplastics (e.g. large plastic items such as plastic bags, water bottles and fishing gear) and microplastics (small plastic particle s generally five millimetres or less in size) persist in the marine environment and result in harmful effects on marine life and biodiversity, as well as negative impacts on human health. In addition, marine plastic litter negatively impacts activities such as tourism, fisheries and shipping. This plastic

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marine life and biodiversity, as well as negative impacts on human health. In addition, marine plastic litter negatively impacts activities such as tourism, fisheries and shipping. This plastic material has the potential to be brought back into the economy by means of reuse or recycling. Studies demonstrate that despite the existing regulatory framework to prevent marine plastic litter from ships, discharges into the sea continue to occur.
1.2 IMO has recognized the importance of preventing pollution by garbage, including plastics, from ships since the adoption of MARPOL Annex V, as well as the dumping of various types of waste, including plastics, into the sea through the Convention on the Pre vention of Marine Pollution by Dumping of Wastes and Other Matter 1972 (London Convention or LC) and its 1996 Protocol (London Protocol or LP). This commitment was reinforced by the IMO Assembly, at its thirtieth session, in December 2017, recognizing t he ongoing problem of marine plastic pollution, as addressed in MARPOL Annex V, which required further consideration as part of a global solution within the framework of ocean governance, in

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marine plastic pollution, as addressed in MARPOL Annex V, which required further consideration as part of a global solution within the framework of ocean governance, in pursuance of the target of Sustainable Development Goal 14 to pre vent and significantly reduce marine pollution of all kinds by 2025.
1.3 IMO recognizes the importance of continued action to manage this global issue. In 2016, the thirty -eighth Consultative Meeting of Contracting Parties to the London Convention and the eleventh Meeting of Contracting Parties to the London Protocol adopted a "Recommendation to Encourage Action to Combat Marine Litter". In 2018, MEPC 73 adopted the Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships by resolution MEPC.310(73).
1.4 IMO has committed to working closely with a number of partners to address the issue of marine plastic litter including, but not limited to:
.1 FAO through the Joint FAO/IMO Ad Hoc Working Group on IUU Fishing and Related Matters (JWG) and the IMO OceanLitter Programme;
.2 the Joint Group of Experts on the Scientific Aspects of Marine Environmental Protection (GESAMP);

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.1 FAO through the Joint FAO/IMO Ad Hoc Working Group on IUU Fishing and Related Matters (JWG) and the IMO OceanLitter Programme;
.2 the Joint Group of Experts on the Scientific Aspects of Marine Environmental Protection (GESAMP);
.3 the UN Environment -managed Global Partnership on Plastic Pollution and Marine Litter (GP3ML);
.4 the United Nations Open -ended Informal Consultative Process on Oceans

and the Law of the Sea (ICP);
.5 the United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA); and
.6 the Intergovernmental Negotiating Committee to develop an international legally binding instrument on plastic pollution, including in the marine environment (INC).

2 Objective
The 2025 Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships has been developed to contribute to the global solution for preventing marine plastic litter from entering the oceans through ship-based activities. This Action Plan provides IMO with a mechanism to i dentify

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SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
contribute to the global solution for preventing marine plastic litter from entering the oceans through ship-based activities. This Action Plan provides IMO with a mechanism to i dentify specific outcomes, and actions to achieve these outcomes, in a way that is meaningful and measurable. The 2025 Action Plan builds on existing policy and regulatory frameworks, and identifies opportunities to enhance these frameworks and introduce new supporting measures to address the issue of marine plastic litter from ships. The 2025 Action Plan also recognizes the actions that have been completed since the adoption of the initial Action Plan in 2018, demonstrating the considerable work undertaken by IMO to address this important issue.
3 Time frames, review and evaluation
3.1 The measures within the 2025 Action Plan should be completed by 2030.
3.2 Specific time frames for individual measures have been captured in the table of actions below and reflected in the revised annex 1 to the Strategy to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships [PPR 12/16/Add.1, annex 8]. Paragraph 4.1 of the Strategy to Address Marine

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SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
actions below and reflected in the revised annex 1 to the Strategy to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships [PPR 12/16/Add.1, annex 8]. Paragraph 4.1 of the Strategy to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships (resolution MEPC.341(77)) provides the definitions for these time frames.
3.3 The 2025 Action Plan will be reviewed after five years with a view to updating the actions based on information submitted by Member States and international organizations on the implementation of the 2025 Action Plan.

4 Actions
Outcome Measures Parent organ Coordinating/ Associated organ Time frame Associated partners
1 Reduction of

marine plastic
litter generated
from, and
retrieved by,
fishing vessels
Consider making the IMO Ship Identification Number
Scheme mandatory for all fishing vessels over
24 metres in length through an amendment to the
Cape Town Agreement once it enters into force
MSC /
MEPC
Mid-term
2 Encourage the ratification of the Cape Town
Agreement
MSC /
MEPC

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SOURCE: MEPC.404(83).pdf
Scheme mandatory for all fishing vessels over
24 metres in length through an amendment to the
Cape Town Agreement once it enters into force